

The Weekend Website

Build a client-ready site with AI in 2 days
— and land your first paying gig.

A no-fluff playbook for Ugandan students who can code but haven't been paid for it yet. Read it in ten minutes. Use it this weekend.

18
DAYS, LIVE

CASE STUDY
delinkhomes.ug — a full real-estate site I built and shipped live in 18 days, on exactly the stack in this guide. Proof this isn't theory: it's the workflow I actually use to get sites in front of paying clients fast.

01 Why speed wins

Clients don't pay for perfect code — they pay to make a problem go away, and they want it gone now. A shop with no website is losing customers every week it waits. So the person who delivers a working, good-looking site this weekend beats the one who promises a flawless build in a month. Speed is the product. Get good at delivering fast and you'll out-earn far better programmers who move slow.

02 The stack

Four tools do the whole job. Nothing exotic — this is a boring, reliable stack that real agencies charge real money for.

Claude Design Turn a client brief into a finished layout in minutes, not days.	WordPress The base. It runs a huge share of the web and clients can update it themselves.
Elementor Drag-and-drop page builder — you assemble the design without hand-coding.	Plugins Forms, security, speed and SEO — the starter kit is in Section 03.

03 The method, step by step

Five moves, in order. Do them in one weekend.

1 • Nail the brief in 20 minutes

Most beginners skip this and pay for it later. Sit with the client, ask five questions, write down the answers. That's your whole spec.

THE 5-QUESTION CLIENT BRIEF

1. What does the business actually do?
2. Who is the customer?
3. What is the **one** action the site should drive? (call, WhatsApp, book, buy)
4. Three websites they like — and why.
5. What pages are needed?

2 • Design with Claude Design

Feed the brief straight into Claude Design and ask for a full layout. Be specific about the one action, the pages, and the look. One good prompt gets you a real starting design:

"Design a mobile-first one-page site for a Kampala real-estate agency. Sections: hero with a 'Book a viewing' button, 3 featured listings, a short about, and a contact form. Clean and modern, lots of white space, one accent colour. The main action is booking a viewing."

3 • Build in WordPress with Elementor

Recreate the layout section by section in Elementor — don't fight the builder trying to match it pixel-for-pixel. Match the structure and the spacing, use your client's real photos and copy, and keep it to the pages in the brief. Working and shipped beats perfect and unshipped.

4 • The plugin starter kit

Install these and a site stops looking like a student project and starts looking client-ready. Forms, security, speed, SEO and backups — the essentials a sharp client (or their tech friend) will check for.

PLUGIN KIT

WPForms	Contact and enquiry forms.
Wordfence	Security and firewall.
OceanWP + Ocean Extra	Theme framework and extra design controls.
Essential Addons	Extra Elementor widgets and sections.
reCAPTCHA	Stops spam on your forms.
Rank Math	SEO — so the site shows up on Google.
LiteSpeed Cache	Caching and speed — fast loads on Ugandan data.
UpdraftPlus	Automatic backups — a pro habit that saves you.

5 • The launch checklist

Five checks that make a site "client-ready." Run them before you hand anything over.

LAUNCH CHECKLIST

- ✓ **Mobile first.** Open it on a phone. Text readable, buttons tappable, nothing broken.
- ✓ **Contact works.** Submit the form yourself and confirm the message actually arrives.
- ✓ **Fast.** Loads in under three seconds with caching on — test on mobile data, not campus wifi.
- ✓ **Findable.** SEO title and description set, and the site submitted to Google.
- ✓ **Clean details.** Real business name in the title, favicon set, WhatsApp/phone visible, no "Hello World" leftovers.

04 Getting paid — the part YouTube skips

You can build a beautiful site and still make zero shillings. This is the section that turns skill into income. Read it twice.

Where your first client actually is

Not on Upwork fighting 200 people. Start with businesses you already know and can walk into. The hostel you live in. Your aunt's salon in Ntinda. The pharmacy near campus. A boda SACCO. Your church. A friend's catering side-hustle. These people already trust you, and most of them have no website or a broken one. That trust is your unfair advantage — use it before you touch cold outreach.

How to price without underselling

Do not charge "student prices." A working business site is worth real money because it brings the client customers. Here's a realistic first-gig range in Uganda:

Simple 3–5 page business site	UGX 400,000 – 800,000
Site with booking / online enquiries	UGX 900,000 – 1,500,000
Domain + hosting setup (yearly, on top)	UGX 150,000 – 250,000
Optional monthly care (updates, backups)	UGX 50,000 – 100,000/mo

Take 50% up front, 50% at launch — always. The deposit is what separates a client from a "friend who was just asking." If money is tight for them, offer a lower "launch price" of UGX 400,000 in exchange for using their site in your portfolio. Never work for exposure alone.

What to say to close it

Keep it about their customers, not about you. A message that works:

"Hi Auntie — I build websites now. Right now when someone searches for your salon online, they find nothing, so they book a competitor. I can build you a clean site this week where clients see your work and book on WhatsApp directly. It's UGX 500,000, half to start. Want me to show you a design first?"

Name the problem, promise the outcome, quote a number, ask one small yes. Then send them a Claude Design mockup before they've even paid — seeing it real is what closes the deal.

THE INVITATION

This guide is the map. The cohort is walking it together.

You can absolutely do this alone — everything you need is above. But most people stall on the messy parts: the first real client, the pricing nerves, the bug at 11pm. The Weekend Website cohort is me walking it with you, on your actual site.

- My direct feedback on the real site you're building.
- Done-for-you WordPress templates — start from finished, not blank.
- A full Claude Design prompt library, tuned for client work.
- Help landing your first paying client — the part that pays for the cohort.

Message me on WhatsApp → wa.me/256745384737



Roland Sankara

Software Engineer (6+ yrs) and author. I believe talent is everywhere but opportunity isn't — so I use my technical experience to mentor others and help them build real careers through digital skills. More at rolandsankara.com.